

TURN

Falguni and
Shane Peacock



Bon Marche in Paris and Saks Fifth Avenue in New York, and ramp romps at international fashion weeks might have brought in the rahs-rahs and media attention, it's increasingly becoming clear as to where the big moolah lies in this fashion free-for-all world. "It's ironic that now when the whole world is looking at India, we are beginning to look at ourselves anew," laughs Bahl. While the Delhi-boy launched his label in 2001, he only turned his attention to Indian wear two years ago. "We are lucky that we can do both western and Indian clothes. Internationally, that's not the case. Big global brands are coming in with a Sabyasachi with his models

with each ensemble priced between Rs 1 lakh and Rs 2 lakh, which was snapped up in three weeks. "Nearly 60 per cent of my business now comes from the domestic market and I expect that to rise with the couture collection. Thankfully, Indian weddings and festivals will never go out of fashion," he says.

While Bahl's business share is divided equally between western and Indian wear, Gupta is beginning to expand his ramp repertoire and lending a



SABYASACHI MUKHERJEE

Bright traditional colours, like red and green shine in kalidar kurtas and flowing ghaghras.



bang. What's going to happen if we discard Indian wear," asks Bahl.

"You can't shy away from the fact that traditional wear is still very popular in India," admits Rocky, who believes the only way to beat international invasion is by capitalising on our traditional cuts and embroideries. "Everyone wants a piece of the India pie, so we should look forward to better our domestic share," he adds. Rocky recently launched a specially crafted 60-piece couture line at Aza, Mumbai,



FALGUNI & SHANE PEACOCK

Contemporary tones of green, blue in velvets and chiffons are tailored into unconventional silhouettes.

"unique perspective" to Indian wear at nearly 15 stores across the country. "In India, there is a lot more money-market share in the bridal wear designer segment. Comparatively, couture or avant-garde western wear is a very niche market," he says. His traditional wear, which retails at Ensemble and Kimaya, bears his individualistic stamp. "Even John Galliano does an outlandish dress for a ramp show and translates it into prêt for store racks," he says. He wants to give a "new twist" to the traditional sari or ghaghra. "My creations have a global look that bring a very sophisticated feel to the Indian market," says Gupta.

Falguni & Shane Peacock too have been bitten by the bridal bug and lured

MANDAR DEODHAR